[20] *Swadesamitran*, 20-9-1906. Sadhu Ramasubbaiyar was the paternal uncle of Sadhu Ganapathy Panthulu, who was closely associated with VOC during this time. Ironically, Sadhu Ramasubbaiyar was one of the vakils initially engaged for VOC's defence when the sedition cases were slapped against him (MPAI, 1908, para 363).

[21] When the Vijayanagara emperor Krishnadevaraya forced all his courtiers to raise a cat, the court jester Tenali Raman, in protest, fed it hot milk; after this experience the cat refused to go anywhere near a milk saucer.

[22] That Indians lacked industry and enterprise was a common view against which the Swadeshi movement had to struggle. A police report of that time recorded the view of a 'native' who approached a prominent European firm in Madras to invest in a mining project with the words: '… *swadeshism* was humbug with which respectable and influential native gentlemen will have nothing to do … It must be run by Europeans. If this firm would only put its name to the project natives would subscribe the capital required in a few days.' (MPAI, 1908, para 1056).

[23] When the distinguished classical Tamil scholar, M. Raghavaiyangar published a long essay in the scholarly journal, *Sentamil* (May–July 1907), on ancient Tamil handicraft and industry, VOC penned a gushing verse epistle to him commending the essay. He stated that he was moved to tears by Raghavaiyangar's reconstruction of the ancient glory of Tamils; contrasting it to the current poverty of India, he was heartened by the Swadeshi revival. For the text of this letter, dated 26-10-1907, see Venkatachalapathy, ed., *Va.Oo.Chiyin Kadithangal*, pp. 35–36. Not incidentally, Pandithurai Thevar, the president of SSNCo, was the chief patron of *Sentamil*.

[24] The maritime achievements of Indians in ancient times were a recurrent theme of much of Indian nationalist writing. Mookerji, *Indian Shipping*, written in the zeitgeist of the Swadeshi movement, and based on extensive historical research, sums up Indian achievements in some detail. Such a narrative also prefaces the socialist Mehta's *Indian Shipping*.

[25] Published in two parts, *Swadesamitran*, 24-9-1906 and 25-9-1906.

[26] *Swadesamitran*, 22-8-1906.

[27] Ibid.

[28] *India*, 1-9-1906.